

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP



- 1 FOUNDATIONS**
- 2 CYBER FUNDAMENTALS**
- 3 PICK YOUR SPECIALIZATION**
- 4 SPECIALIZATION ROADMAP**
- 5 LAB PORTFOLIO**
- 6 ADDITIONAL**
- 7 JOB PREPARATION**
- 8 APPLY FOR JOBS**

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

STEP 1 – FOUNDATIONS

Free Courses:

Professor Messer - CompTIA A+

<https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLG49S3nxzAnn7PDGQ17m5AYbDRhnW7vOb>

Cisco Operating Systems Basics

<https://www.netacad.com/courses/operating-systems-basics?courseLang=en-US>

Professor Messer - CompTIA Net+

https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLG49S3nxzAnI_tQe3kvnmeMid0mjF8Le8

Cisco Networking Basics

<https://www.netacad.com/courses/networking-basics?courseLang=en-US>

Lab Ideas:

I. TryHackMe

Modules: Windows and AD Fundamentals, Linux Fundamentals, Networking

Rooms: Windows Powershell

<https://tryhackme.com/MeeraTamboli>

II. NMap

<https://nmap.org/>

III. Wireshark

<https://www.wireshark.org/>

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

STEP 2 – CYBER FUNDAMENTALS

Free Courses:

Professor Messer - CompTIA Sec+

<https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLG49S3nxzAnl4QDVqK-hOnoqcSKEIDDuv>

Paid Courses:

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate:

<https://imp.i384100.net/c/6455422/2153398/14726>

Industry Certifications:

<https://www.comptia.org/en-gb/certifications/security/>

Lab Ideas:

I. TryHackMe

Modules: Introduction to cybersecurity, building your cybersecurity career

Paths: Pre-security, security 101

<https://tryhackme.com/MeeraTamboli>

II. HackTheBox

<https://hacktheboxltd.sjv.io/9V94RW>

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

STEP 3 – PICK YOUR SPECIALIZATION

Free Quiz To Help Figure Out Your Interest in Cybersecurity:

<https://www.coursera.org/resources/cybersecurity-career-quiz-which-role-is-right-for-me>

Videos to Help Figure Out Your Interest in Cybersecurity:

<https://youtu.be/8GhCDXbznPw?si=MalZxuxuHqm0NRTs>

Blogs To Help You Figure Out Your Interest in Cybersecurity:

<https://tryhackme.com/resources/blog/which-cyber-security-career-path-is-right-for-you>

<https://www.comptia.org/en-gb/blog/find-the-right-cybersecurity-career-path-for-you/>

Labs To Help You Figure Out Your Interest in Cybersecurity:

TryHackMe

Room: Careers in cybersecurity

<https://tryhackme.com/MeeraTamboli>

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

STEP 4 – SPECIALIZED ROADMAP

Specialization	Free and Paid Courses	Certifications	Hands-on Labs / Projects
SOC / Incident Response	Free: Security Blue Team – Introduction to SOC Analyst Paid: Security Blue Team – BTL1 Training	CompTIA Security+ → Microsoft SC-200 → BTL1	LetsDefend • TryHackMe • CyberDefenders
Pentesting & Application Security	Free: PortSwigger Web Security Academy Paid: TCM Academy – Practical Ethical Hacking	eJPT → PNPT → OSCP	PortSwigger Labs • Hack The Box • OWASP Juice Shop • DVWA
Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC)	Free: Microsoft Learn – Security, Compliance & Identity (SC-900) Paid: Simply Cyber – GRC Analyst Masterclass Paid: UnixGuy – GRC Mastery	CompTIA Security+ → ISO/IEC 27001 Lead Implementer / Lead Auditor	Build a Risk Register • NIST CSF Mapping • ISO 27001 Gap Assessment
Digital Forensics	Free: BlueCape Security – DFIR Foundations Paid: BlueCape DFIR Training	CompTIA Security+ → GIAC GCFA	CyberDefenders DFIR • Autopsy • Velociraptor
Security Engineering / Architecture	Free: Microsoft Learn – Security Learning Paths Paid: TCM Academy – Practical DevSecOps	Microsoft AZ-500	Wazuh • DetectionLab • Microsoft Defender XDR • Microsoft Sentinel
Cloud Security (AWS & Azure)	AWS (Free): AWS Skill Builder AWS (Paid): AWS Skill Builder Individual Azure (Free): Microsoft Learn (AZ-900 + SC-900) Azure (Paid): Microsoft Applied Skills / Instructor-Led Training	AWS: AWS Certified Security – Specialty Azure: Microsoft AZ-500	AWS: Explore AWS Free Tier Account Azure: Explore Azure Free Tier Account

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

STEP 5 – LAB PORTFOLIO

Videos To Help You With Lab Ideas For Your Lab Portfolio:

AI Pentesting Lab using Penlagent AI:

<https://youtu.be/8owBYniof3U?si=dfzgt9JWD3bbZCNb>

Offensive + Defensive Lab using Safeline WAF:

https://youtu.be/Cp2sWmiXt3k?si=sI_JAlvwKFLJ3QML

AI Hacking using Shannon AI:

https://youtu.be/-lsXreM_ZOI?si=dARE12E21yZMnyx9

Blogs To Help You Build Your Lab Portfolio:

<https://tryhackme.com/resources/blog/how-to-build-a-cybersecurity-portfolio-that-gets-you-hired>

<https://www.cybrary.it/blog/hands-on-cybersecurity-training-building-cybersecurity-projects-beginners-resume>

Sites To Use For Building Your Lab Portfolio:

I. Wordpress

<https://wordpress.com/>

II. Google AI Studio

<https://aistudio.google.com/>

III. GitHub

<https://github.com/>

IV. Notion

<https://www.notion.com/en-gb>

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

STEP 6 – ADDITIONAL QUESTS

Resources To Help You Stand Out:

I. CTFs (Capture the Flag):

Guidance: <https://youtu.be/gYFuxSIQxB0?si=ZORtakBFaSxV0qDW>

CTF Site Options:

CTF Events: <https://ctftime.org/>

PicoCTF: <https://picoctf.org/>

CTFLearn: <https://ctflearn.com/>

II. Bug Bounty:

Bug Bounty Site Options:

HackerOne: <https://www.hackerone.com/>

BugCrowd: <https://www.bugcrowd.com/>

III. Cybersecurity Blogs:

My Blog Just For Ideas:

<https://meeratamboli.medium.com/>

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

STEP 7 – JOB PREPARATION

&

STEP 8 – APPLY FOR JOBS

Resources To Help You Prepare For Your Job:

Tips Before Your First Interview – Preparation tips:

<https://youtu.be/B4t5DLzWUg4?si=MvF9ZBg0FvXj-t3v>

Interview Tips – Making a good impression:

https://youtu.be/GeZ5FNfABug?si=QJCxv3gEwP-LQ3_0

How I Got a Job Without Applying To 100s of Jobs:

<https://youtu.be/UACgvPBmVsM?si=LjY4OG3g3JfjlyE9>

What The 1% Job Seekers Are Doing Differently:

<https://youtu.be/M-C5FXtEdD4?si=gZwJnc807asVKFcV>

Basic Interview Questions:

<https://youtube.com/playlist?list=PLGiG9xknS5Lj1uu44lghC9g09h9HmIvtO&si=mXFpuhiZsxnDLolb>

CV Guidance:

Free CV Building Workshop:

<https://youtu.be/NGqIN90nU4U?si=pt30ugFDLDIHTJIN>

CV Template (Paid):

https://topmate.io/meeratamboli/1044809?utm_source=public_profile&utm_campaign=meeratamboli

LinkedIn Guidance:

The Right Way to Set Up Your LinkedIn:

https://youtu.be/4GTnj65j_k?si=nF5w_RmziI_opTGY

How To Use LinkedIn the Right Way:

<https://youtu.be/y5zbLmFp-Gg?si=GAS9fcL8-4kQpyt7>

Scared to post on LinkedIn? Watch this:

https://youtu.be/QHYLEiJ5I_w?si=NKd8-WwGOlrOzZCm

FREE CYBERSECURITY ROADMAP

BONUS TIPS!

Bonus Resources:

I. AI Security:

OWASP Gen AI: <https://genai.owasp.org/>

LLM Top 10: <https://genai.owasp.org/llm-top-10/>

TryHackMe AI1 Certification: <https://tryhackme.com/MEERAAI1>

FAQs:

Will AI Replace SOC Analysts?

<https://youtu.be/SRE2HMUyeHM?si=4KBQdM2TQsYqylxN>

Top Use Cases of AI in Cybersecurity:

https://youtu.be/wUed_5EVDNg?si=l1M2WpHJm42JainJ

Will AI Replace Cybersecurity Jobs?

<https://youtu.be/F71CYzB4Ar4?si=XbjC9igb48ZTLC2U>

II. Staying Updated:

Bleeping Computer: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/>

Hacker News: <https://thehackernews.com/>

III. Coding in Cybersecurity:

Do You Need Coding in Cybersecurity?

<https://youtu.be/A-HcOgvnGmM?si=yVmIzu-xOgJVGaaF>

Top 5 Cybersecurity Roles That Don't Require Coding:

<https://youtu.be/A03pBqjo4VU?si=ePXH7NJirMzQfln4>